

Karnataka gets the centre's approval for 1243 EV chargers

The Centre approved Karnataka's ₹1.23 billion proposal for 1243 EV charging stations under PM E-DRIVE, part of a wider ₹5.03 billion plan covering 4874 chargers across states and CPSEs. A new Unified Bharat e-Charge platform is planned to simplify charging access and payments, while the industry urged 'right to charge' policies for urban EV users.

India is looking to redesign the DLI Scheme

The Indian government is planning DLI 2.0 semiconductor scheme after weak results from DLI 1.0. New rules will allow larger Indian firms to partner globally, with 51% domestic ownership and 49% foreign capital. MeitY may raise incentive limits as only 24 of 60 applicants were approved, and commercialisation lagged. Revised rollout expected by May-June will boost India's chip ecosystem.

ECMS faces early hurdles in electronics push in India

India's Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS) is facing early hurdles, as the industry missed the 15-day deadline to submit plans for product design, Six Sigma quality, talent development, and local sourcing. Ongoing consultations reflect challenges in moving beyond assembly-led manufacturing toward design-driven electronics production, covering PCBs, connectors, lithium-ion cells, and domestic value addition.

India eyes six-month critical minerals reserve plan

India is considering a strategic reserve of critical minerals equal to six months of demand, covering lithium, cobalt, nickel, copper, and rare earths for the electronics, EV, and energy-storage sectors. The plan, under discussion with industry, aims to reduce import dependence, counter supply risks linked to China, and support the National Critical Minerals Mission.

INTERNATIONAL news

Samsung considers halting consumer electronics sales in China

Samsung Electronics is considering ending home appliance and TV sales in China in 2026 amid intensifying competition from local brands, while retaining its Chinese plants as export hubs. Samsung said no final decision has been taken. This comes as Samsung crossed a \$1 trillion market value, becoming Asia's second trillion-dollar tech firm after TSMC, driven by AI-led semiconductor optimism.

Apple hits \$111 billion in the March 2026 quarter

Apple posted a record \$111 billion March-quarter revenue in 2026, up 17% YoY, marking its third straight quarter above \$100 billion. iPhone revenue jumped 22%, led by the iPhone 17 series and China demand. Macs, iPads, wearables, and services also grew, while supply chain strength helped Apple absorb rising component costs and expand market share.

Indium wins \$3.2 million grant for gallium recovery

Indium Corporation secured a \$3.2 million US DOE grant under the TRACE-Ga programme to develop domestic recovery of high-purity gallium from manufacturing scrap. The Rome, New York project targets semiconductor and defence supply chains, aiming to restore US gallium production and scale output to at least one metric ton annually of 99.99% purity.

Altair secures \$50 million and completes spinoff from Sony

Altair has spun out of Sony Semiconductor Solutions, raised \$50 million in funding led by Pitango Group, and will operate independently while Sony retains a stake. The company will focus on low-power IoT connectivity and 5G eRedCap, targeting smart meters, industrial sensors, smart cities, and AI-linked devices through its upcoming ALT1550 modem.

Tesla bets \$25 billion on AI future

Tesla plans to spend over \$25 billion in 2026, nearly triple 2025 levels, accelerating its shift toward AI, robotics, and autonomous mobility. Investments include Optimus robot production, Cybercab robotaxis, AI chips, semiconductor manufacturing, and battery expansion, while converting Fremont into a robotics hub despite expected negative free cash flow.

Renesas acquires Irida Labs to boost edge AI

Renesas Electronics Corporation has acquired Greece-based Irida Labs to strengthen edge AI and machine vision capabilities. Irida's visual perception software will integrate into Renesas 365, supporting industrial, robotics, IoT, healthcare, agriculture, and smart city applications while simplifying AI deployment on embedded processors.

India and Japan deepen quantum and medical technology agreements

India and Japan expanded technology ties with agreements covering medical devices and quantum technologies. New pacts between AMED, ICMR, and DST will support healthcare innovation, while a quantum cooperation LoI targets computing, secure communications, sensing, and materials research.

India-New Zealand FTA boosts electronics exports

The India-New Zealand FTA, signed on April 27, 2026, grants zero-duty access for 100% of Indian exports, benefiting electronics and electrical machinery by removing tariffs of up to 5%. The pact supports MSMEs, manufacturing competitiveness,

and global value chain integration, alongside a US\$20 billion investment commitment, technology cooperation, and mobility pathways for STEM graduates and skilled professionals.

India and Vietnam to boost collaboration in semiconductors, AI, and robotics

India and Vietnam forged a tech alliance that targets electronics growth through joint semiconductor fabrication, AI supply chain diversification, and robotics. Backed by a \$25 billion bilateral trade goal, the pact integrates India's Digital Public Infrastructure with Vietnam's manufacturing sector.

Bihar targets 30% EV sales by 2030

The Bihar Cabinet, chaired by Chief